Statement of Work (SoW)

Submitted to Waraqa LLC

July 24, 2023

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Introduction

This statement of work (SoW) has been prepared by Amnet based on the ongoing communication with Waraqa Publishing (hereafter referred to as "Waraqa") and the project specifications shared by Waraqa during the project kick-off and a subsequent proposal submission. The document is intended to ensure that both Amnet and Waraqa are on the same page about the project requirements. The SoW also confirms the scope of work and other project-specific details. This SoW is a key factor in ensuring the success of the project.

Background

Amnet ContentSource Private Limited (hereafter referred to as "Amnet") has submitted the proposal and pricing to Waraqa for the deployment of Nvcleus for the purpose of using it as an author submission system. Waraqa Publishing House has a proven and well-respected record in journal publication, upkeep, and online footprint management that make them ideal for providing its customers with all their needs. It is their mission to become a household name in the Middle East for all services in medical journal creation. To this end, Waraqa employ or have ties with companies specialized in content review accredited board to guarantee the best possible outcome for its projects. With 1000+ qualified professionals at Amnet, Waraqa can be assured of services that are cost-effective, timely, high quality, and completely in line with your visions and objectives.

Amnet's technology team comes with rich experience building browser-based platforms for the publishing ecosystem. The team is driven by a Technology & Digital Transformation Head and a Principal Architect cumulatively carrying 45+ years of IT experience and 20+ years of publishing experience with a deep appreciation for content and an extensive background building HTML platforms, microservices capabilities, and cloud technologies. The flagship platforms they have built have received widespread adoption among researchers and publishers, processing millions of articles, and are powered with instant browser pagination.

The team is currently building a powerful Unified Content Framework, to automate its content orchestration pipeline as its digital transformation strategy, envisioning each business capability as individual microservices that can be abstracted to build a content-agnostic automation framework. In addition, the team is investing heavily in building capabilities into its browser-based Book Publishing and Journal Publishing Platforms.

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Nvcleus: A Multichannel Journal Publishing Platform

Nvcleus, powered by Kotahi, is a modern scholarly publishing platform that provides support to develop, manage, and distribute content digitally, across multiple channels and in various formats. It is a single comprehensive ecosystem that encompasses the complete publishing spectrum—content creation, production, and distribution. The platform is also very modular, extensible, and configurable—all elements can be changed if required. In addition, Nvcleus leverages modern real-time communication protocols and together with the Single Source Publishing design, the entire system offers publishers enormous future proofing and workflow optimization opportunities. All the production stakeholders use the same source file, thereby reducing the production TAT. The system uses push-button publishing wherein typesetting happens in real time. The CSS-based typesetting engine, from the underlying HTML content, generates multiple file formats and deliverables such as XML, ePub, web and print PDFs.

Nvcleus has been built using the PubSweet framework specifically designed to build flexible, scalable, and extensible publishing platforms and is core to a multitude of platforms that demonstrate these principles including Hindawi's Phenom.

Nvcleus has three components, XSweet—an open source conversion tool and the underlying publishing framework known as PubSweet, Wax Editor—a web-based editorial platform, and Paged.JS—a new age pagination framework, XSweet is a transformation tool that converts the contents of a Word and LaTeX document into relevant information—the text, formatting, semantic styles, notes, etc.—and then converts it into HTML. XSweet does much more than simply extract content from .docx file; it does a lot of enhancements as follows:

- Recognize plain-text URLs and turn them into hyperlinks
- Apply headings and semantic markup, based on visual formatting such as font size and bold weight
- Apply common copyediting cleanup to text as it is uploaded, such as converting double spaces to single ones
- Convert hyphens between numerals to en dashes
- Remove any number of spaces before or after em dashes
- Convert series of three periods to ellipses
- Replace pairs of adjacent hyphens with em dashes
- Convert en dashes surrounded on both sides by spaces to em dashes
- Surround each equal sign with one space on either side
- Remove spaces adjacent to tabs

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- Remove spaces at the beginning and end of paragraphs
- Remove tabs at the end of paragraphs
- Remove empty paragraphs
- Convert single and double straight quotation marks and back ticks to smart quotation marks
- Insert hair spaces between single and double quotation marks
- Force punctuation marks to match the formatting of the previous word

Wax Editor (copyediting)—Wax editor is a sophisticated web-based editing tool that has all the features of a standard word processor. We can create, edit and format content, place images, and communicate with other production stakeholders. Wax can be configured to have different combinations of tools and styles, or to have custom functionality added to it. Wax Editor offers the following features:

- **Styling**—A styling panel with all the block or paragraph styles that can be applied to the content. These named styles apply the correct semantic markup to each element.
- **Formatting and inserts**—The current character formatting options are bold, italics, small caps, superscript, and subscript, math equations and symbols. There are also tools for inserting hyperlinks, ornaments, and special characters; highlighting text; and adding syntax-highlighted code snippets.
- **Unicode/special characters**—Wax has a Unicode character repository linked to the editor which allows the user to simply drag and drop the required character anywhere into the document. The repository provides a wide array of Unicode characters, symbols, and accented characters that are frequently in application.
- **Illustrations**—Images (including figures and illustrations) can be added and each can have a unique caption. It is important to use the image's caption interface rather than writing a free sentence under the image which will enable Nvcleus to use the correct design specifications when exporting to PDF and ePub.
- **Notes**—The formatting toolbar contains a button for inserting a note where the cursor is in the text. This will create a note reference in the text and open an appropriately numbered note in the notes panel. Deleting a note reference will also delete the note itself and subsequent notes will automatically renumber. We can also insert note references inside another note's text.
- **Track changes**—When turned on (not all users have rights to turn track changes on or off), this feature tracks text that is added/deleted/or moved. During production and copyediting, this feature may be turned off, if required. Hovering over a change displays the name of the user who made the change. Different colors are assigned to edits according to the user’s roles. To see what text would look like if all changes are accepted, the markup can be temporarily hidden. This is purely a visual aid and has no effect on the actual content.

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- **Comments**—Authors and editors can communicate with each other using the Wax comments feature. Selecting text will make a comment bubble appear to the right. Clicking on it will open a writing area where the user can type in required text and hit the return key to save the comment (if the user clicks outside the comment window before hitting return, the comment will be lost).
- **Keyboard shortcuts**—There are a number of keyboard shortcuts mapped to different functions of the Wax word processor.
- **Search and Replace**—Using the magnifying glass icon, the user can avail the search and replace facility during real-time content editing.

Paged.js (typesetting)—Paged.js is a web-based automated typesetting tool that can take HTML and render it into PDF—open source or proprietary. It follows the CSS standards that are accepted by the W3C. Paged.js is used to create layouts and allows the user to render the paged content in the browser and through a command-line batch processor, the content can be previewed live in the browser. Styling the content, reloading, and rendering may be done as many times as required. The architecture of Paged.js is modular, which means it can be extended by small modules written in JavaScript to achieve typesetting and layout functions to meet specific publisher needs. Paged.js works based on the following principles:

- **CSS style sheet**—CSS style sheets contain the necessary design specifications for pages like font size, margins, padding of elements, colors, styles, etc. The CSS Paged Media module describes the way a page model partitions a scroll flow into discrete pages. A section of the HTML content is associated with a named page model in the CSS. The specific page layout is applied when this element of the section is encountered. A document can have several different page models. When the final output is rendered, pages are automatically created.
- **Layout**—Journals have specific artifacts like table of contents, running heads and footers, page numbers, indexes and so on. These artifacts are not directly encoded in the content but rather automatically added by the rules defined in the CSS. For print it is also necessary to size and position the content to match the page and to break content in an appropriate way to support the meaning of the text.
- **Print previews**—Paged.js allows for a preview of the print styles in the browser before printing to PDF. Paged.js implements polyfills by parsing the CSS style sheets and fragmenting the content into pages using JavaScript. This also allows for extending supported features with other JavaScript libraries, such as custom hyphenation settings or a math typesetting library.
- **JATS XML extraction**—Nvcleus allows the users to extract a valid Journal Article Tagging Suite (JATS) XML file. Users do not need specialized knowledge of XML or JATS to take advantage of this feature.

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Features

- **Authentication:** Nvcleus supports ORCID authentication by default. But it can be integrated with any authentication system that has a restful API.
- **Submission Form:** Submission data can be captured by user entry with the Submission Form. The creation and ongoing maintenance of the Submission Form is done by the Journal Admin with the internal Form Creation user interface
- **Dashboard:** The Dashboard is considered the entry point of the application. From here a user can see all the articles they are working on and create new submissions. The usual actions of creating articles, renaming, archiving, and deleting is provided. Sorting of articles by title, status, and author is provided for those working on many projects. Sort preferences are remembered between sessions as a user's preferred sort order.
- **Workflows:** Nvcleus supports multiple workflows including PRC (Publish, Review, Curate) and the submission, peer review, and publishing of everything from preprints, micropubs, journals, and books to exciting new types of publishing.
- **Review models:** Nvcleus enables publishers to use a number of different review models: open and single-blind. Reviewers can have individual reviews or collaborate on a shared review.
- **Editing:** Nvcleus is designed around the idea of editing and authoring articles in the browser, using Wax, Coko's full-featured web-based word processor.
- **Realtime updates and chat:** Nvcleus is built to get the best from web collaboration and supports real time notifications, chat, synchronized updates and more. Live chat (both text and video) functionality can be used to communicate with authors or collaborate as an editorial team.
- **Metadata:** The in-browser form builder can be used to design submission forms to capture and manage metadata specific to each journal's workflow.
- Ability to assign the Editor for review the article
- Ability to invite the reviewer for peer review process
- Ability to review the article and make a decision by Reviewer
- Ability to review the peer review comments and make a decision by Editor
- Ability to review the Editor comments by Author and make a corrections and clarify the queries
- **Single-source methodology:** Nvcleus supports a single-source publishing workflow where all stakeholders are able to access the same manuscript during content creation (peer review, editing, etc.) and production (copyediting, semantic tagging, etc.). This obviates the need to track and control documents across multiple systems.
- **Versioning:** Versioning is supported so that changes to a submission can be easily inspected.
- **Exporting:** Currently, Nvcleus exports to PDF, JATS, and HTML. A GraphQL API makes it possible to connect Nvcleus's data to other systems (like PubMed) as needed.

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- **Integrations:** Authorization is through ORCID; more integration with ORCID in the future is possible. Nvcleus can register DOIs for articles via integration with Crossref.
- **Reports:** Admin users of Nvcleus get a dashboard showing the progress of articles through the system.

Advanced Features

Nvcleus boasts a range of sophisticated features designed to streamline and automate numerous processes, resulting in significant time savings. The following are among the notable features offered by Nvcleus:

- AI-based manuscript auto-structuring and diagnostics
    - Prefills author submission forms
- Automates JATS delivery
- Production editor to support post acceptance activities
    - Capable of editing both mathematical & chemical formulas
    - Integrated STEM based language & mechanical editing tools
- AI-based Reference structuring
- Floaters linking, automated cleanup utilities and citation management
- CrossRef Integrations: DOI registration, reference validation and indexing
- Option to publish the articles directly to Nvcleus publishing platform

Some of the advantages of Nvcleus are listed below:

- Digital-first workflow
- Browser-based peer review
- Communication on a real-time basis through text or video
- Integrated, role-based notification system
- Rating form for reviewers/editors
- Highly collaborative editing environment with math and table editing features
- CSS-based typesetting engine that enables pagination of any HTML content and PDF creation on the fly
- One platform and multiple formats: XML, HTML, PDF, ePub.

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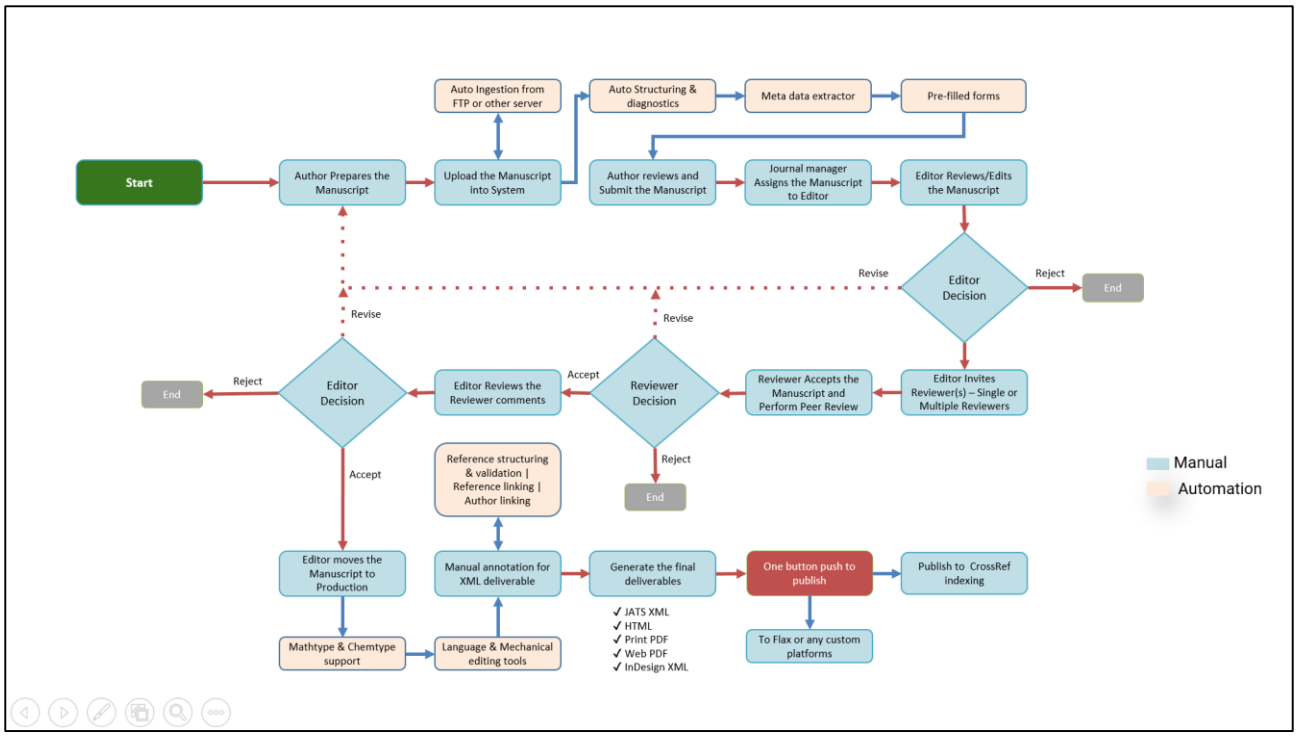
Nvcleus for Journals Workflow



Infrastructure

The platform will be hosted on Amnet's environment.

Hosting	AWS
Uptime	99.99%
Storage & Scaling	50GB per journal Can be scaled on a pay-as-you-go mode

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Security

Nvcleus adheres to rigorous security protocols, prioritizing the utilization of private networks for the majority of its servers. Public access is restricted to web servers exclusively, with no customer data being stored on these servers.

To ensure data isolation, our databases operate at the journal level, ensuring that each customer possesses an individual database server, and their data remains segregated from other clients. These databases are housed within a private network, with limited accessibility granted solely to web servers. Access to the databases is subject to stringent auditing procedures and is exclusively permitted in accordance with established security guidelines.

Furthermore, static content is securely stored in AWS S3, preventing public access. The web server solely possesses read access to this content.

Moreover, due to Nvcleus being built on an open-source publishing technology stack, an extensive community of experts continually scrutinize the code for any potential vulnerability. Any identified vulnerabilities are promptly addressed to maintain the platform's robust security posture.

Timeline

The project (deployment of author submission system) will be delivered within 10 business days from the date of sharing the project-specific inputs.

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Investments

Item	Unit of pricing	Price	Remarks
Peer review management - Manuscript submission to acceptance	Per submission	$10.00	Above 1000 submissions, $8.00 per submission
One time template creation	Per journal	$300	Template will be created as per journal specific layout requirements
Journal Management	Per Journal, Per year	$3,000	
Customization	Per feature	$30/hour	In case of customization to build specific features, we will provide an estimate and proceed on development once approved.
Training	Per program	$1,200	6 hrs training package with a training time of 2 hr per session. Additional training available at $300 per hour.

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Signatures

The parties hereto, having read this proposal in its entirety, do agree thereto in each and every particular.

Agreed and Accepted:

Accepted By	**Accepted By**
Venu Prasad Menon	
Signature	Signature
Name: Venu Prasad Menon	Name: Dr Theeb Ayedh Alkahtani
Title: Managing Director	Title: Founder and Senior Consultant
Date: 24-07-23	Date:
[Amnet ContentSource Pvt. Ltd]	[Waraqa LLC]

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